

ALPHA-OMEGA LENS — CANONICAL SPINE

Status: Canonical (Load-Bearing)

This document defines the structural spine of the Alpha-Omega Lens system. It governs ordering, attachment, versioning, and expansion rules for all current and future books, chapters, and companion materials.

1. Purpose of the Spine

The spine exists to prevent drift.

It establishes: - what is core and immutable - what may expand - how additional material attaches without altering meaning

The spine is not interpretive. It is architectural.

2. Canonical Core (Locked)

The Canonical Core consists of **Book One**:

1. **Orientation: Seeing Structure Before Meaning**
2. **Systems as Pass-Throughs**
3. **Common Misuses of the Lens**

Rules: - Language may be edited only for clarity, not substance - No ideology, prescriptions, or policy proposals may enter the core - The glass narrative is permitted only as an *Author's Note*, not as doctrine

The Canonical Core answers one question only:

What is the lens, and how does it see?

3. Attachment Layers

All additional material must attach through one of the following layers:

Layer A — Author's Notes

- Narrative, analogies, personal origin
- Optional to the reader

- Cannot modify definitions

Layer B — Applied Chapters (Book Two)

- Domains: democracy, religion, prisons, poverty, war, business, organizations
- Must begin with structural description
- No moral conclusions allowed inside analysis

Layer C — Companion Materials

- Case studies
- Field notes
- Business implementations
- Tools, prompts, and workflows

Layer D — External Nodes

- Reddit discussions
- Public prompts
- Talks, interviews, apps

External nodes **never** modify upstream layers.

4. Book Structure

Book One — The Lens (Canonical)

- Immutable
- Short
- Teachable in one sitting

Book Two — The World Through the Lens

- Modular
- Chapters may be added or removed
- Each chapter stands alone

Book Three — Implementation

- Optional
 - Contextual
 - Time-bound
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5. Versioning Rules

- Canonical Core: v1.0 (locked)

- Additions increment minor versions (v1.1, v1.2...)
 - Major version changes require a new spine
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6. Editorial Law

If a sentence answers *what should be done*, it does not belong upstream.

If a sentence explains *what is happening structurally*, it is admissible.

If there is ambiguity, the sentence is removed.

7. Governing Principle

The lens does not solve problems.

It reveals where structure failed to remain transparent.

Everything else is downstream choice.

End of Spine